



SUGARS

More than 185 million tons of sugar is produced each year. More than 80 percent of it comes from sugar cane. This is grown on a large scale on plantations in the tropical areas of Brazil, Cuba, India, China, Australia, Mexico, the Philippines, Thailand, and the US. The rest of our sugar comes from sugar beet, which is a vegetable. Sugar beet grows in the cooler climates of Europe, the US, Canada, China, and Japan.

Sugar cane

Sugar cane is a tropical plant. It grows best in places that get plenty of sunshine and lots of rain.

Sugar cane is a very tall grass, like rice and cereals.

The sugar is stored inside the stalk, in a firm pulp.

The stalks of a mature plant are about two inches (five centimeters) thick.



Workers watch out!

The sugar plantations can be home to the deadly bushmaster snake. Enormous bird-eating spiders also nestle in the thick foliage.



The canes are cut close to the ground because this is where the most sugar collects.

After the cane has been harvested, healthy stumps will regrow into new plants.

Sugar beet

Sugar beet is a root vegetable. It looks like a giant parsnip. It grows best in places that have warm summers and cool or cold winters.

The leafy tops of the plants are cut off before the sugar beet is lifted. The tops can be used for animal feed.



The sugar is stored in the thick root.